

AUSTRALIAN E-BIKE REGULATIONS 2026

National Compliance & Parental Liability Guide — All States & Territories

NATIONAL STANDARD: 250W MAXIMUM · 25 KM/H MOTOR CUT-OFF · EN 15194 CERTIFICATION

1. UNIVERSAL RULES (ALL STATES)

- **250W Maximum:** Motor power must not exceed 250W on any public road or path.
- **25 km/h Cut-off:** Motor assistance must stop at 25 km/h in all jurisdictions.
- **No Throttle Cruising:** Throttle-only riding above 6 km/h is illegal nationwide.
- **EN 15194 Standard:** Required on all new e-bikes sold from Feb 2026 (NSW). Mandatory for all road use nationally from **1 Mar 2029**.
- **Over 250W = Motorcycle:** Requires registration, insurance and a licence. Riding without these is a criminal offence.
- **Helmet Required:** An approved bicycle helmet is mandatory in all states.

QUICK COMPLIANCE CHECK

- ☐ Motor rated **250W or less**?
 - ☐ Motor assist cuts out at **25 km/h**?
 - ☐ **No throttle** above 6 km/h?
 - ☐ **EN 15194** certificate or mark?
 - ☐ Rider wearing an **approved helmet**?
- All yes = road legal in all states.*

2. STATE-BY-STATE KEY DIFFERENCES

State	Footpaths	Age	Key Note
NSW	Adults: 10 km/h	—	Seizure & crush powers (Mar 2026). 500W grace period until 1 Mar 2029.
VIC	Under 13 only	—	Strictest footpath rule in Australia.
QLD	12 km/h cap	16+	Seizure powers (1 Jul 2026). Age 16 + learner's licence from 31 Aug 2026.
WA	Shared paths	16+	Ride Safe inquiry (Dec 2025). National device-standards push underway.
SA	All ages	—	E-scooters/PMDs legalised Jul 2025. Rules under review 2026.
TAS	All ages	—	Mirrors national standard.
ACT	All ages	—	Extensive shared path network in Canberra.
NT	All ages	—	Mirrors national standard.

3. PARENTS: IS YOUR HOME AT RISK?

If an underage rider causes an accident on an illegal e-bike:

1. **NO INSURANCE:** Home policies exclude “unregistered motor vehicles.” Illegal e-bikes fall under this category.
2. **PERSONAL LIABILITY:** Parents can be sued for millions in medical costs and damages.
3. **ASSET LIQUIDATION:** Your house, savings and assets can be seized to pay legal debts.

TYPICAL PENALTIES

Unregistered Vehicle: \$686–\$2,200+
Uninsured Vehicle: \$686–\$5,500+
Unlicensed Rider: Court attendance
No Helmet: \$25 (NT) to \$518 (QLD)
Footpath (adult, NSW/VIC): Up to \$2,200
Destruction Order: Final — no return
Amounts vary by state. Check your state page for exact figures.

Police have active **seizure & crush** powers for non-compliant e-bikes (Mar 2026).
Roadside **Dyno Units** verify the 25 km/h cut-off on the spot.
500W bike owners: **grace period until 1 Mar 2029** only.

FULL STATE-BY-STATE GUIDE



australia-ebike-laws.netlify.app

OFFICIAL STATUTORY REFERENCE

Road Rules 2014 (each state) | Road Transport Act 2013 (NSW) | Road Vehicle Standards Act 2018 (Cth)
For educational purposes only. Always refer to your state's current legislation. Information current as at August 2026.